

Concluding thoughts for Step Four

Addressing issues with spending – whether you struggle to part with cash even for things that you really want or need, or you use spending as a crutch when things are difficult, or you flit anxiously between the two – can take time and practice. But as so much of our relationship with money revolves around our spending and saving practices, it's vital that we learn to feel comfortable and in control of these behaviours. Using the insights and techniques in this step, I hope that you can now recognize the unhealthy elements of your spending behaviour, and start to heal them. Being able to do this will help you to work towards that feeling of calm control over your money – you'll never be left wondering where all of your cash has gone a few days before pay day, and feelings of buyer's remorse and spending anxiety should be few and far between.

Control over the flow of cash out of your bank account will enable you to tell that voice – the voice of self-doubt, the one that wants you to define yourself as 'bad with money' for ever more – to kindly shut up, and it will help you to lay those financial demons and feelings of guilt to rest, finally. It will also, crucially, give you a brilliant foundation on which to make plans for your financial future, which is what we'll be discussing in Step Five. I'll meet you there.